SUMMARY

- PHP offers support for many databases. Open source relational databases are well represented, as are many commercial products.
- The dbase_create function creates a dBase database. The fields argument is an array of arrays that describe fields. Each array may have up to four elements. In order, they are name, type, length, and precision.
- When rows are deleted in a dbase database, they are simply marked for deletion. Use the dbase_pack function to permanently remove these rows, thus packing the database.
- The DBA functions abstract communications with databases that conform to the style of Berkeley DB database systems.
- Use dba_optimize to optimize a database, which usually consists of eliminating gaps between records created by deletes.
- filePro is a relational database by fP Technologies. There are versions for win32 and SCO UNIX. PHP only supports reading from filePro databases.
- PHP includes support for two parts of the Informix API, ODS and IUS.
- The ifx_copy_blob function makes a copy of an existing blob and returns the identifier to the new blob.
- The ifx_query function executes a query and returns a result identifier, which most of the other Informix functions require.
- InterBase is a full-featured database that spent much of its life as closed-source and proprietary.
- mSQL or Mini SQL is a lightweight database management system from Hughes Technologies. There are a handful of mSQL functions that exist simply for backward compatibility.
- The msql_db_query function is identical to msql_query except that it specifies a database rather than using the database selected with msql_ select_db.
- The msql_list_dbs function returns a result identifier as if the database were queried with msql_query.
- MySQL is a relational database with a license that allows you to use it cost-free for most noncommercial purposes.
- Open database connectivity (ODBC) has become an industry standard for communicating with a database. The model is simple. Client software is designed to use an ODBC API.
- The odbc_pconnect function operates similarly to odbc_connect. A connection is attempted to the specified Data Source Name (DSN) and a connection identifier is returned.